

Italy

September 2023

Italy has been a State Party to the 1951 Convention relating to the Status of Refugees since 1954. **A UNHCR country office was established in 1954**; which in 2020 a multi-country office (MCO) covering Italy, the Holy See and San Marino.

UNHCR **prioritizes inclusion and solutions** for refugees and asylum-seekers, including through the “Welcome project”, “Integration Charter”, “Community matching” and various legal pathways (e.g. **humanitarian corridors**).

UNHCR works in close coordination with Italian authorities and IOM, within an *ad hoc* Working Group established by the Ministry of Interior (Moi), to provide **protection and solutions** for refugees and migrants arriving to Italy.

UNHCR POPULATION STATISTICS (as of end-2022)*

Refugees	308,677
Asylum-seekers	102,060
Stateless people	3,000

Top three countries of origin*

Refugees		Asylum-seekers	
Ukraine	164,930	Bangladesh	19,422
Nigeria	20,742	Pakistan	19,196
Afghanistan	18,303	Egypt	13,955

*UNHCR 2022 End-Year Trends and UNHCR [data finder](#)

HIGHLIGHTS

133,655 arrivals by sea between Jan – Sept 2023, and 7,642 by land between Jan – Aug 2023

So far in 2023, 58% of individuals who arrived by sea were disembarked following Search and Rescue (SAR) operations. Sea crossings departed primarily from Tunisia, followed by Libya and Türkiye. New arrivals originated mostly from Guinea, Côte d'Ivoire, and Tunisia. Land arrivals increased by 20% compared to the same period in 2022, with top three arrivals coming from Afghanistan, Bangladesh, and Pakistan.

UNHCR Launches Field Office in Milan

On 31 March, UNHCR Italy inaugurated its field office in Milan. The High Commissioner for Refugees, Filippo Grandi, took part in the inauguration [event](#).

Vademecum on vulnerabilities

UNHCR supported the drafting and adoption of a **Vademecum handbook**, providing [guidelines](#) for actors in the national asylum system on identification, referral, and response to persons with specific needs. This will be piloted locally in 2023.

UPDATE ON THE GLOBAL REFUGEE FORUM (GRF)



11 pledges registered for Italy

since 2019 in the areas of **education, jobs and livelihoods, protection capacity, resettlement and solutions**.

Since 2019, the Government of Italy submitted two pledges on the national resettlement programme and on the social-labour inclusion of refugees. Academic institutions, Municipalities, faith-based organisations and sport actors submitted the other pledges on humanitarian corridors, education pathways and inclusion.

‘Welcome. Working for Refugee Integration’

The UNHCR “Welcome. Working for Refugee Integration” [initiative](#), realized in cooperation with the Ministry of Labour, Confindustria and the Global Compact Italia, contributes to the Global Compact on Refugees (GCR) objective of enhancing refugee self-reliance. Other Italian good practices relate to mitigating the risk of GBV, strengthening child protection, education pathways, labour inclusion, awareness raising, and refugee participation.



Welcome. Working For Refugee Integration

On 26 June, **UNHCR awarded 167 private companies** with the Welcome logo for creating job opportunities for nearly 9,300 refugees in 2022. **Welcome. Working for Refugee Integration** is a UNHCR initiative facilitating the creation of **22,000 labour pathways for refugees** across more than 520 companies since 2017, with the overall goal of supporting their socio-economic inclusion.

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Key Priorities

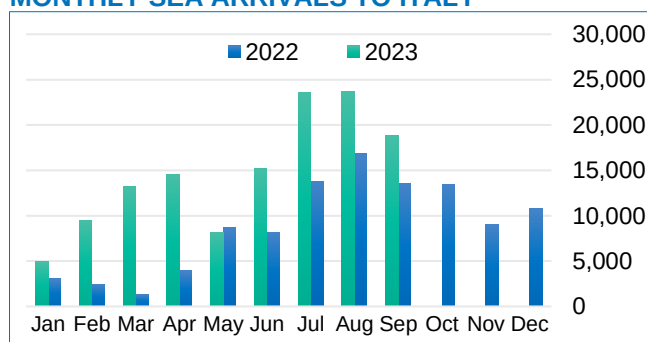
- **Access to territory:** UNHCR works with national authorities to ensure people arriving by sea are provided with adequate assistance and information. As of August 2023, **97,762 people received relevant information**. At Italy's northern borders, UNHCR carried out **outreach activities**, providing information to new arrivals and referring them to relevant services.
- **Labour pathways:** UNHCR supported the introduction of labour pathways through Law 50/2023, which establishes **quotas for the legal entry** of refugees and stateless people from origin and transit countries.
- **Social cohesion:** The **Community Matching** national initiative, now active across 10 cities, contributed to the inclusion of refugees by facilitating their matching with local communities.
- **Inclusion:** In the framework of the collaboration between UNHCR and local institutions, and after the signature of the **Integration Charter**, multifunctional integration centres managed by Municipalities have been supported in Turin, Bari, Milan, Rome and Naples, to foster socio-economic inclusion of refugees.
- **Gender-based violence (GBV):** With UNICEF and the Italian Civil Protection, UNHCR developed a **Practical Guide** aimed at providing a framework, including standards and tools to mainstream GBV **risk mitigation**, and **prevention of sexual exploitation and abuse** in the Italian reception system.

Working with Partners

- UNHCR established a strong cooperation with the new Government, advocating for **domestic and international policies in support of forcibly displaced and stateless people**. The office collaborated with national and local authorities, as well as with other key stakeholders, including academia, Faith-Based Organizations, and the private sector

- 2022 saw the highest financial contribution to UNHCR by Italy, with USD 97.4 million.
- **Cooperation with the Holy See.** On 10 June, High Commissioner Filippo Grandi attended the "Not Alone" event, the first world meeting on human fraternity, in the Vatican. On that occasion, he signed the "**Declaration on human fraternity**" along with 33 Nobel Laureates.
- In 2023, UNHCR implemented **17 partnerships with NGOs**, covering various protection needs. During the year, engagement on GBV and primary and specialized health services was scaled up, and UNHCR field presence was reinforced.

MONTHLY SEA ARRIVALS TO ITALY



Statelessness

- Italy has acceded to both the 1954 and 1961 UN Conventions on Statelessness.
- UNHCR and the Italian Ministry of Interior signed a Memorandum of Understanding aimed **at improving the statelessness determination procedure** and exploring the opportunity to set up **referral mechanisms** between the asylum and the statelessness procedures.

UNHCR Presence in Italy

Staff:

94 National Staff
 36 Field presence
 7 International Staff

Offices:

1 MCO Italy Office in Rome
 1 Field Office in Milan

Financial information* (September 2023)

* Information relates to Italy, the Holy See and San Marino.

Financial requirements

\$22.1 M

Funded 55%
\$12 M

Funding gap 45%
\$10.2 M



UNHCR is grateful for the support from our top government donors of unearmarked, softly earmarked, and earmarked funding:

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UNHCR is also grateful for the generous contributions from the private sector and individuals.